Maziar Kianimoghadam Jouneghani

PhD Candidate in AI | NLP Researcher | Alessandria, Italy

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Bio

I hold a Master's degree in Language Technologies and Digital Humanities from the University of Turin. I am currently a PhD candidate in AI at the University of Eastern Piedmont. My research focus is multilingual NLP, harmful online content and computational social science.

Research Interests

Multilingual and Cross-Cultural NLP, Computational Social Science (CSS), Information Disorder, Human-in-the-Loop AI (HITL), Explainable AI (XAI), Fairness, In-Context Learning (ICL).

Education

PhD in Computational Sciences and Technological Innovation — Nov 2026 – Oct 2029 (expected)

University of Eastern Piedmont (UPO) — Alessandria, Italy

Department: Science and Technological Innovation (DISIT)

Track: Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

Master's Degree in Language Technologies and Digital Humanities — Oct 2023 – Jul 2026

University of Turin — Turin, Italy

Final Grade: 106/110

Thesis: "Culturally Adaptive Explainable LLM Assessment for Multilingual Information Disorder"

Supervisors: Prof. Viviana Patti (Supervisor), Dr. Marco Antonio Stranisci (Co-supervisor)

Research Summary: Extended a multilingual baseline study on the InDor corpus to investigate where current LLMs show cultural blindness and produce culturally misaligned outputs in information disorder assessment. Designed and tested a retrieval-based In-Context Learning framework to connect model reasoning to community-annotated exemplars. These exemplars are dynamically retrieved through semantic similarity at inference time from an encoded version of the corpus. Evaluated across Persian and Italian subsets using a combination of automated metrics and native-speaker human evaluation on three tasks of classification, span detection and rationale generation. [Link]

Bachelor's Degree in English Language Translation — Sep 2013 – Feb 2017

Shahrekord University — Shahrekord, Iran

Final Grade: 17.07/20

Academic Focus: Linguistics and Translation Studies.

Publications

Published

- Gemelli, S., et al. "Beyond Fake News Detection: A Community-Based Study of the Multicultural Nature of Information Disorder." *Proceedings of the Fifteenth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)*. Co-author: **Jouneghani, M. K.** [Link]

  This work presents the InDor corpus, a community-developed multilingual dataset for information disorder, studying how culture and language shape its perception and evaluating two MoE models on it. I contributed to sourcing manipulative media reports, coordinating community data collection, and annotating the Farsi and English subsets. This dataset and these baseline findings are the empirical foundation of my thesis.

- **Jouneghani, M. K.** "MKJ at SemEval-2026 Task 9: A Comparative Study of Generalist, Specialist, and Ensemble Strategies for Multilingual Polarization." *Proceedings of the 20th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2026)*. **System ranked 2nd in the Farsi (Persian) and Burmese language tracks of Subtask 1.** [Link]

  Solo-authored system paper for multilingual polarization detection across 22 languages, comparing generalist, specialist, and ensemble techniques per language, with final configurations chosen by development performance across 4 to 13 candidates per track.

- **Jouneghani, M. K.** "Culturally Adaptive Explainable LLM Assessment for Multilingual Information Disorder: A Human-in-the-Loop Approach." *Peer-reviewed, accepted and presented at the 1st Workshop on Information Disorder (InDor26), at LREC 2026 (Non-archival)*. [arXiv] [Proceedings]

  Solo-authored paper proposing a Human-in-the-Loop framework to align LLMs' assessment of information disorder with native-speaker rationales. This paper is the initial idea of my thesis framework, submitted as an ongoing study. My thesis is the application and a pilot test of this study.

Preprints

- Piva, H. C., Ashraf, S., **Jouneghani, M. K.**, Longo, A., Damiano, R., Flek, L., Stranisci, M. A. "Conspiracy Frame: A Semiotically-Driven Approach for Conspiracy Theories Detection." Preprint available on [arXiv].

  Introduces the Conspiracy Frame, a semantic representation of conspiratorial narratives derived from frame-semantics and semiotics, and the Con.Fra. dataset of annotated Telegram messages, evaluating LLMs' ability to detect conspiracy theories in- and out-of-domain. I contributed to annotation, presented the scheme at the workshop, and authored the related work section.

Academic and Research Experience

aequa-tech, srl Turin, Italy

NLP Research Intern Feb 2025 – Jul 2025

- Part of a 12-member international team building the InDor corpus, contributing to different phases of the project: sourcing manipulative media reports, coordinating social media outreach for community data collection, and annotating the Farsi and English subsets.

University of Turin (Department of Psychology) Turin, Italy

Research Assistant, BIP (Brain Plasticity and Behavior Changes) Group Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

- Assisted with human-subject experimental sessions across two cognitive studies: participant recruitment, hardware setup, data collection, and preliminary processing of physiological signals (EEG, ECG, EDA, HRV).

Scholarships and Awards

PhD Scholarship, University of Eastern Piedmont 2026 – 2029

EDISU Piemonte Scholarship, Master's Degree, University of Turin 2023 – 2026

Reviewing

Reviewer, 20th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2026), 2 papers

Technical and Research Skills

Programming and Tools: Python (data preprocessing, NLP pipeline scripting, evaluation scripts, research prototyping), Hugging Face Transformers, sentence-transformers, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, HTML.

NLP Methodologies: Fine-tuning encoder models (e.g., XLM-RoBERTa, mDeBERTa), ensemble strategies, In-Context Learning (ICL), retrieval-based frameworks, Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) workflows, cross-lingual augmentation, model evaluation (LLMs and classifiers).

Data and Linguistic Research: Multilingual dataset curation, annotation workflows, and linguistic analysis.

Languages: English (C2), Persian (Native), Qashqai Turkish (Native), Italian (A2).

Selected Coursework Projects

SVM vs. Multilingual LLM for Italian Information Disorder Detection 2026
Compared a traditional SVM classifier against a multilingual LLM to detect problematic news content in Italian, and examined how each approach behaves differently when identifying manipulative framing.

Comparing Neural Architectures for Handwritten Character Recognition 2025
Designed and trained two custom CNN architectures with different layer configurations and fine-tuned an EfficientNet model, then compared their performance on the EMNIST dataset to study their strengths, weaknesses, and differences when classifying visually similar characters.

Hate Speech, Irony, and Stance Detection in Immigration-Related Tweets 2024
Annotated a social media corpus for hate speech, irony, and author stance in tweets about immigration, and compared annotation patterns across annotators with different social media usage profiles to study bias and disagreement in subjective labeling tasks.

Distant Reading of Popular Music Lyrics Across Seven Decades 2024
Used distant reading and corpus methods, including co-occurrence network analysis, to trace thematic and stylistic change in popular music lyrics from the 1950s to the 2010s across multiple genres.

Professional Experience

Digital Marketing & SEO Specialist *(Various Roles)* 2020–2023

Worked in SEO, web content, and digital marketing roles across multiple organizations before pursuing my Master's degree.

Volunteering

Volunteer, LREC-COLING 2024, Turin, Italy May 2024

Volunteer, Third International Conference on Beauty and Change, Turin, Italy Oct 2024